Contributing to Urban Climate Adaptation Tools

Thank you for your interest in contributing! This repository thrives on community input from practitioners, researchers, and climate adaptation professionals worldwide.

Ways to Contribute

1. 🆕 Add a New Tool

Know a publicly accessible climate adaptation tool that's not listed? We'd love to include it!

Requirements for new tools:

- Must be publicly accessible (free, freemium with meaningful free tier, or free trial/demo)
- Must focus on urban climate adaptation (heat, flooding, sea level rise, nature-based solutions, etc.)
- Must be actively maintained (updated within last 3 years)
- Must have documentation or user guides available
- Must work at urban/neighborhood/building scale

How to submit:

1. Fork this repository
2. Create a new file using the tool template (replace with notion and google doc)
3. Place it in the appropriate category folder
4. Add screenshots to `assets/tool-screenshots/`
5. Update the category README with your tool
6. Submit a pull request

2. ✏️ Improve Existing Tool Profiles

Help us keep information current and comprehensive:

- Update outdated links or information
- Add screenshots or examples
- Include case studies you know about
- Expand descriptions or use cases
- Add learning resources or tutorials
- Correct errors or improve clarity

3. 📝 Share Case Studies

Document real-world applications in the `case-studies/` folder:

- Describe the project and challenge
- Explain which tools were used and how
- Share outcomes and lessons learned
- Include visuals if possible
- Provide contacts or links for more info

4. 📚 Create Guides or Tutorials

Help others use these tools effectively:

- Write how-to guides for specific workflows
- Create comparison guides between similar tools
- Develop tutorials for combining multiple tools
- Document common pitfalls and solutions
- Translate existing content to other languages

5. 🐛 Report Issues

Found something wrong?

- Broken links

- Outdated information
- Tools that no longer exist
- Incorrect categorization
- Missing important tools

Open an issue with details and we'll fix it!

Submission Guidelines

For Tool Profiles

Required Sections:

- Overview with clear description
- Access & cost information
- Key features (minimum 3)
- At least one use case
- Official documentation link

Recommended Sections:

- Real-world examples
- Screenshots or visuals
- Comparison with alternatives
- Integration opportunities
- Learning resources

Quality Standards:

- Write clearly and concisely
- Use neutral, factual language
- Verify all links work
- Test the tool yourself if possible
- Cite sources for case studies or examples

For Case Studies

Structure:

1. **Context**: City/region, climate challenge, stakeholders
2. **Approach**: Which tools were used and why
3. **Process**: How the tools were applied
4. **Results**: Outcomes and impact
5. **Lessons**: What worked, what didn't
6. **Resources**: Links to project info, reports, contacts

Format:

- Use the case study template in `case-studies/template.md`
- Include 2-4 images (maps, diagrams, photos)
- Keep to 800-1500 words
- Add references and links

Writing Style

- **Clear**: Write for an international audience; avoid jargon or define it
- **Concise**: Get to the point; no marketing speak
- **Practical**: Focus on how people actually use the tools
- **Neutral**: Present facts; avoid promotional language
- **Inclusive**: Consider diverse user needs and contexts

Pull Request Process

1. **Fork and Branch**: Create a branch with a descriptive name (e.g., `add-heat-tool-xyz` or `update-flood-factor`)
2. **Make Changes**: Follow the templates and guidelines above
3. **Test Links**: Verify all URLs work and tools are accessible
4. **Update Indexes**: If adding a tool, update:

- Category README
- Main README stats
- Related tools section in similar tool profiles

5. **Commit Messages**: Use clear, descriptive messages:
   - ✅ `Add Climate Engine to data platforms category`
   - ✅ `Update Flood Factor with 2025 data release`
   - ❌ `Update stuff`
   - ❌ `Fix`
6. **Submit PR**: Include:
   - Summary of changes
   - Why the addition/change is valuable
   - Any relevant links or context
   - Screenshots if applicable
7. **Review Process**: Maintainers will review within 1 week. We may ask for clarifications or modifications.

Verification Requirements

Before submitting a new tool, please verify:

- [ ] Tool is publicly accessible (tested personally)
- [ ] Links work and point to correct resources
- [ ] Tool has been updated within last 3 years
- [ ] Documentation exists and is accessible
- [ ] Tool fits the urban climate adaptation focus
- [ ] Profile follows the template structure
- [ ] Information is accurate and up-to-date
- [ ] Screenshots included (if applicable)

- [ ] Neutral, factual tone used

Code of Conduct

Our Standards

- Be respectful and professional
- Welcome diverse perspectives and experience levels
- Focus on what's best for the community
- Accept constructive criticism gracefully
- Show empathy toward others

Unacceptable Behavior

- Harassment, trolling, or personal attacks
- Publishing others' private information
- Spam or self-promotion
- Disruptive or unconstructive criticism

Enforcement

Violations may result in temporary or permanent ban from contributing. Report concerns to [maintainer email].

Recognition

Contributors will be:

- Listed in tool profile metadata
- Acknowledged in release notes
- Featured in annual contributor highlights (optional)

Questions?

- Open a GitHub Discussion for general questions

- Open an Issue for specific problems
- Email [maintainer contact] for sensitive matters

License

By contributing, you agree that your contributions will be licensed under the same MIT License as the repository.

Thank you for helping build a valuable resource for climate adaptation practitioners worldwide! 🌍💚